

Test Data Management

Test data, synthetic data, anonymization, seeding, isolation and privacy in QA work.

What test data is

It is the data required to execute scenarios in a controlled way: users, products, orders, permissions, states and business combinations.

Synthetic data and privacy

Prefer fictitious or anonymized data when possible. Real personal data requires controls consistent with internal policies and applicable law.

Isolation and repeatability

A good test should know how to create, locate or restore its data. Shared test data increases flakiness and conflicts across executions.

Automation

Factories, fixtures, seeds, setup APIs and post-test cleanup help make suites reproducible and parallelizable.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

Before blaming automation for a failure, confirm that the test data is still in the expected state.